

# Rayner Bestard



Award-winning Unreal Engine Generalist and Technical Designer with over 8 years of experience developing high-profile games, including Dark Life: Excalibur (PlayStation Talents 2021: Game of the Year), Kristala, FussyFox - Mission to Mars, and Gold Fever. Proficient in Blueprints, C++, delivering advanced gameplay mechanics, AI systems, cinematics implementation, and web3-integrated economies across multiplayer, and mobile titles. Co-founded an indie studio, leading cross-functional teams to create prototypes and secure funding. Skilled in Behavior Trees, UMG, multiplayer replication, and console/mobile optimization, with a proven track record of driving performance and player engagement. Passionate about crafting innovative, polished experiences that push technical and creative boundaries

## CONTACT

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## Work Experience

### Astral Clocktower Studios

Gameplay Programmer | Technical Designer  
Sep. 2023 - Present

Kristala - Souls-like action RPG developed in Unreal Engine 5

- Programmed core character mechanics (movement, combat, abilities) using Blueprints and C++, delivering responsive and immersive gameplay.
- Collaborated with animators to integrate character animations via Animation Blueprints and notifies, achieving seamless combat and traversal transitions.
- Implemented NPC AI with Behavior Trees, creating dynamic enemy behaviors.

## Skills

- Blueprints Visual Scripting
- Behavior Trees
- Animation Blueprints
- Multiplayer Replication
- Mobile Optimization
- Console Optimization
- Game Design
- Documentation
- Team Leadership
- Cross-Functional Collaboration
- Project Management
- Technical Game Design
- Code Migration
- C++
- Gameplay Programming
- AI Programming

- Work on design and implementation of traversal mechanics (vaulting, climbing, pool swing, wall running, wall jumping).
- Created user-friendly tools to facilitate feature integration with the design department.

## **Insane Game Studios | Madrid Spain**

Co-Founder | Lead Game Developer Mar.2023 - Present

- Co-founded the studio, leading creative and technical development of Unreal Engine-based games from concept to prototype.
- Programmed gameplay mechanics (combat, movement, systems) using Blueprints and C++, delivering engaging player experiences.
- Collaborated with artists and designers to integrate assets and implement level designs, ensuring visual and functional quality.
- Guided a small team to meet project milestones

## **Fusyona | Canada**

Gameplay Programmer | Technical Designer | Oct. 2022 - Mar.2025

FusyFox - Mission to Mars - UE5 third-person multiplayer shooter with web3 integration

- Engineered core gameplay systems using Blueprints and C++, ensuring robust functionality for arena-based combat.
- Optimized multiplayer performance with replication and networking, supporting concurrent players with minimal latency.
- Developed modular weapon and character systems using Gameplay Ability System (GAS), enabling customizable player builds.
- Designed user interface with Unreal Motion Graphics (UMG), delivering intuitive menus and HUD for multiplayer arenas.
- Implemented class-based skills and weapon mechanics, integrating web3 features for blockchain-based in-game assets.
- Collaborated with designers and artists to refine gameplay mechanics and matchmaking systems, meeting client specifications.

- Animation Programming
- Cinematic Programming
- User Interface Design
- Multiplayer Development
- Network Replication
- Agile Development
- Performance Profiling
- Blockchain Integration



## **Languages**

- Spanish
- English

## **ZERO Studios | United States**

Lead Gameplay Programmer | Technical Designer | Jul.  
2020 - Nov.2024

Dark Life: Excalibur – Award-winning Souls-like RPG in Unreal Engine 4  
(PlayStation Talents 2021: Best Game for the Press, Game of the Year)

- Engineered core systems (progression, inventory, quests) using Blueprints and C++.
- Authored the Game Design Document (GDD), defining core mechanics, narrative, and progression.
- Designed and implemented combat and vaulting mechanics in Blueprints and C++, enhancing player precision and mobility with motion warping.
- Developed advanced enemy and boss AI systems using Behavior Trees, creating dynamic patterns and challenging encounters.
- Built a seamless cinematic-to-gameplay transition system, integrating cinematics with gameplay for fluid narrative flow.
- Designed user interface with Unreal Motion Graphics (UMG), ensuring intuitive menus and HUD for PlayStation and PC.
- Led C++ code migration and optimization, achieving 60 FPS on PS5 and reducing load times.

## **Bitter Cherry Productions**

Gameplay Programmer | Nov.2020 - Aug.2023

Gold Fever The Promise Land – Web3 survival RPG with third-person shooter mechanics in Unreal Engine 4 & 5

- Implemented core systems (progression, combat, survival) using Blueprints and C++, integrating blockchain for decentralized economy.
- Developed animation logic, companion AI, and enemy behaviors using Animation Blueprints and Behavior Trees.
- Designed a dynamic camera system adapting to character states and environmental contexts.
- Built inventory system and user interface with Unreal Motion Graphics (UMG), enhancing player interaction.

- Engineered character-environment interactions, including resource gathering and NFT item mechanics.
- Led programming team, coordinating tasks to meet project milestones and ensure code stability.

## **University of Havana | Havana Cuba**

Professor | Sep.2020 - Oct.2022

- Professor in charge of courses related to Web applications development. Specifically the flows related to the front-end.
- Wordpress platforms deployments and development of institutional portals.

## **IRIS Productions, University of Havana | Havana Cuba**

Software Developer | Sep.2013 - Oct.2022

- Projects management
- In charge of project management and implementation of a development methodology software for the work of development teams.
- Software engineer
- Member of the software development team for the computerization of university processes and maintenance and support of computer applications related to academic management.



## **Education**

### **University of Informatics Sciences | Havana Cuba**

Software Engineering , Informatics Science Engineering  
| Sep.2007 - Jul.2013

### **Vocational High School Institute of Exact Sciences Vladimir Ilich Lenin | Havana Cuba**

Exact Sciences , Bachelors degree | Sep.2003 -Sep.  
2006

## Softwares

- Unreal Engine 4
- Unreal Engine 5
- Blender
- Visual Studio
- C++
- JetBrains Rider
- Jira
- Trello
- ClickUp
- Git

## Awards

### **Best Game of the Year, PlayStation Talents Awards 2021 (Dark Life: Excalibur)**

Recognized for leading gameplay programming and technical design, delivering an award-winning Souls-like RPG with innovative mechanics and immersive narrative for PlayStation and PC platforms

### **Best Game for the Press, PlayStation Talents Awards 2021 (Dark Life: Excalibur)**

Highlights critical acclaim and media reception, focusing on polished gameplay.